

TOOLS AND UTILITIES

These are the nifty variety, the functional ones, the “Oh-what-would-I-do-without-you” type of apps

With millions of apps out there, your smartphone is as nifty as Batman’s utility belt, or the fighter aircraft in SwatKats, which always an unbelievable number of nifty things stored. Ok, maybe an exaggeration there, but there is seemingly no limit or boundary to what one can do with his or her phone these days. Prior to the age of smartphones, ‘feature’ phones or ‘dumb’ phones could not do most of the things modern-day smartphone apps can. Smartphones were termed ‘smart’ because they allowed for richer apps that could take advantage of each and every part of their hardware. The apps mentioned below do just that — you’ve got easier-to-use file managers and photo gallery applications. You’ve got apps that control downloads progressing on your computer from anywhere in the world, and ones that keep your kids from messing up your phone every time you give it to them to play games. There are apps that will help you save precious battery (which in today’s smartphones almost never seems to be enough), or run a bunch of benchmark tests to gauge whether the phone actually is worth its printed specifications.